

Session 1

AI Leadership Foundations

From AI curiosity to confident, responsible AI use.

Generative AI

Prompting

Verification

Opportunity

Baseline

90 minutes learning + 30 minutes Q&A

Saturday • August 22, 2026 • 3:00–5:00 PM Juba Time

90 minutes: learn → try → reflect

A beginner-friendly, practical introduction to using AI as a leadership tool.

01

AI fundamentals

15 min

02

Prompt engineering

25 min

03

Human verification

15 min

04

Opportunity
assessment

20 min

05

Capability baseline

15 min

The session is intentionally interactive.

You will leave with prompts, a verification habit, and a personal AI starting point.

01 • FUNDAMENTALS

What is Generative AI?

GenAI Tools



ChatGPT

Gemini



Copilot

A

Claude

```
function withdraw(amount) {  
  if (amount > balance) {  
    fail("you have no cash")  
  } else {  
    balance = balance - amount  
  }  
}
```

Traditional Software:
Follows rigid, explicitly
programmed instructions.



Generative AI

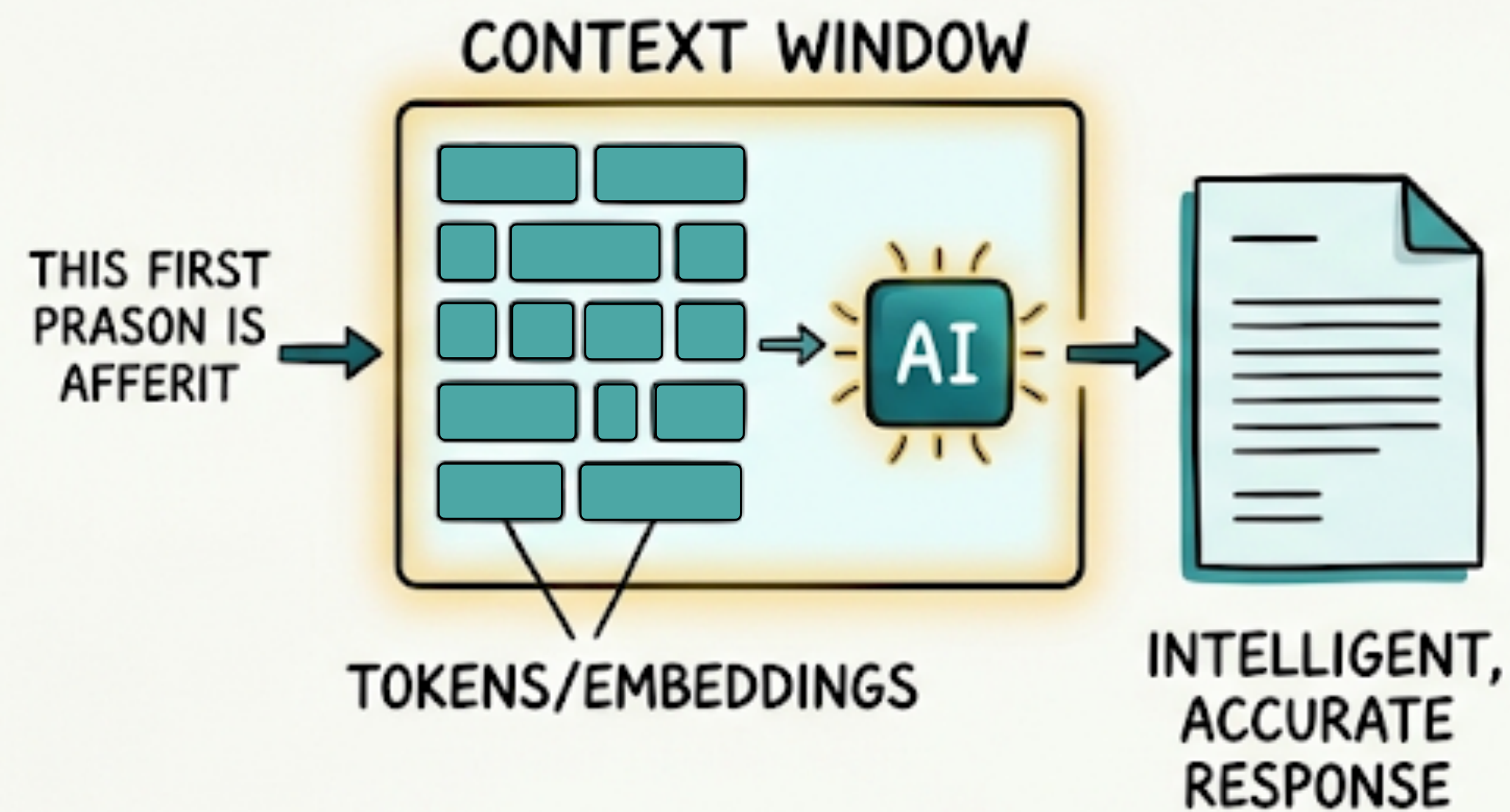


Intelligence as a service.

Essentially, intelligence is now available as a service in the cloud. It can create new content based on patterns it has learned.

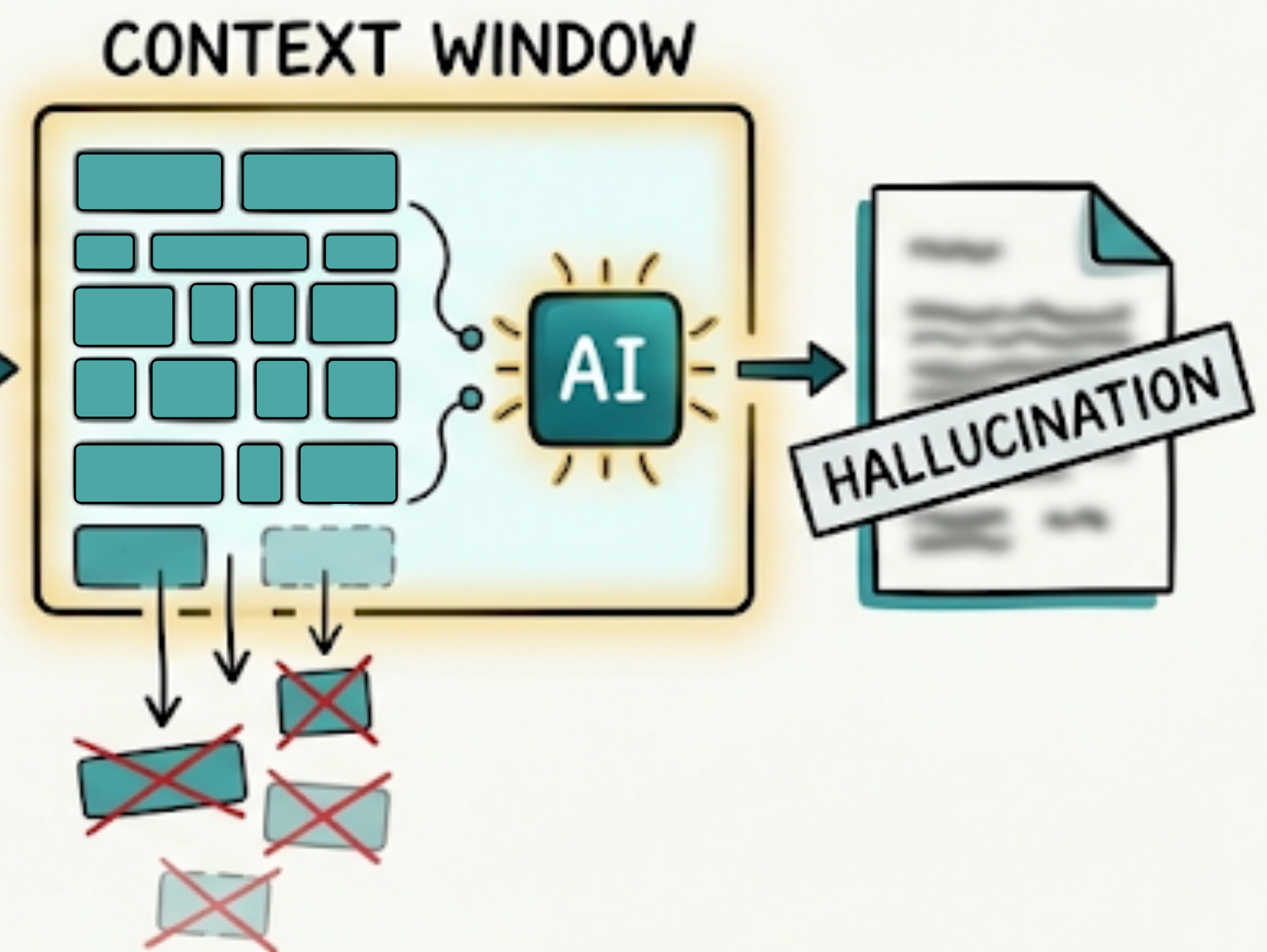
What is Generative AI?

SCENARIO 1: SUCCESSFUL AI RESPONSE



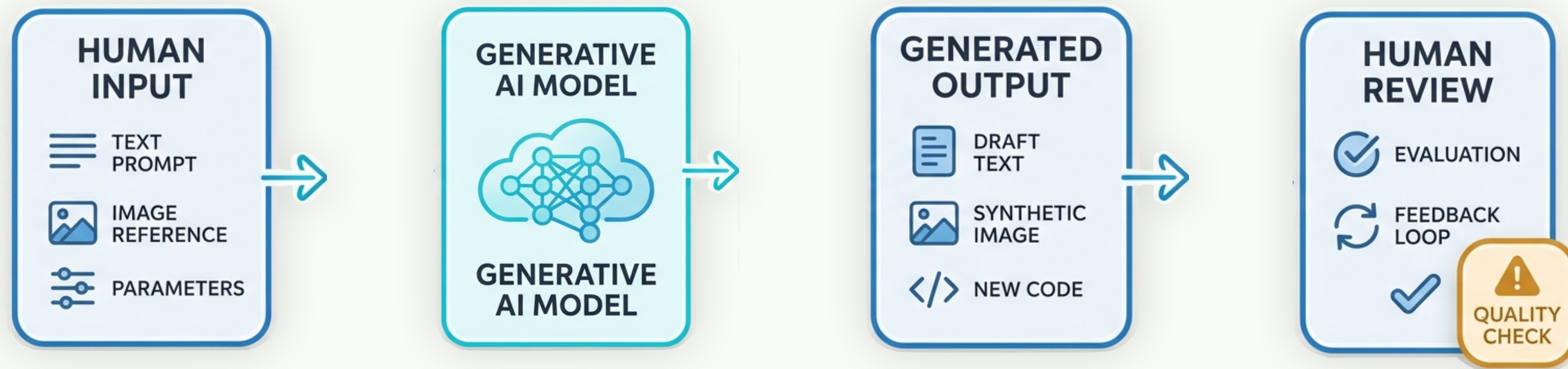
SCENARIO 2: EXCEEDED CONTEXT & HALLUCINATION

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What is Generative AI?

A simple mental model before we touch the tools.



AI generating an answer does not mean that the answer is correct.

AI is a co-pilot — not an oracle.

AI can assist with the work, but the human remains responsible for evaluating the output and making the decision.

Human takes responsibility.

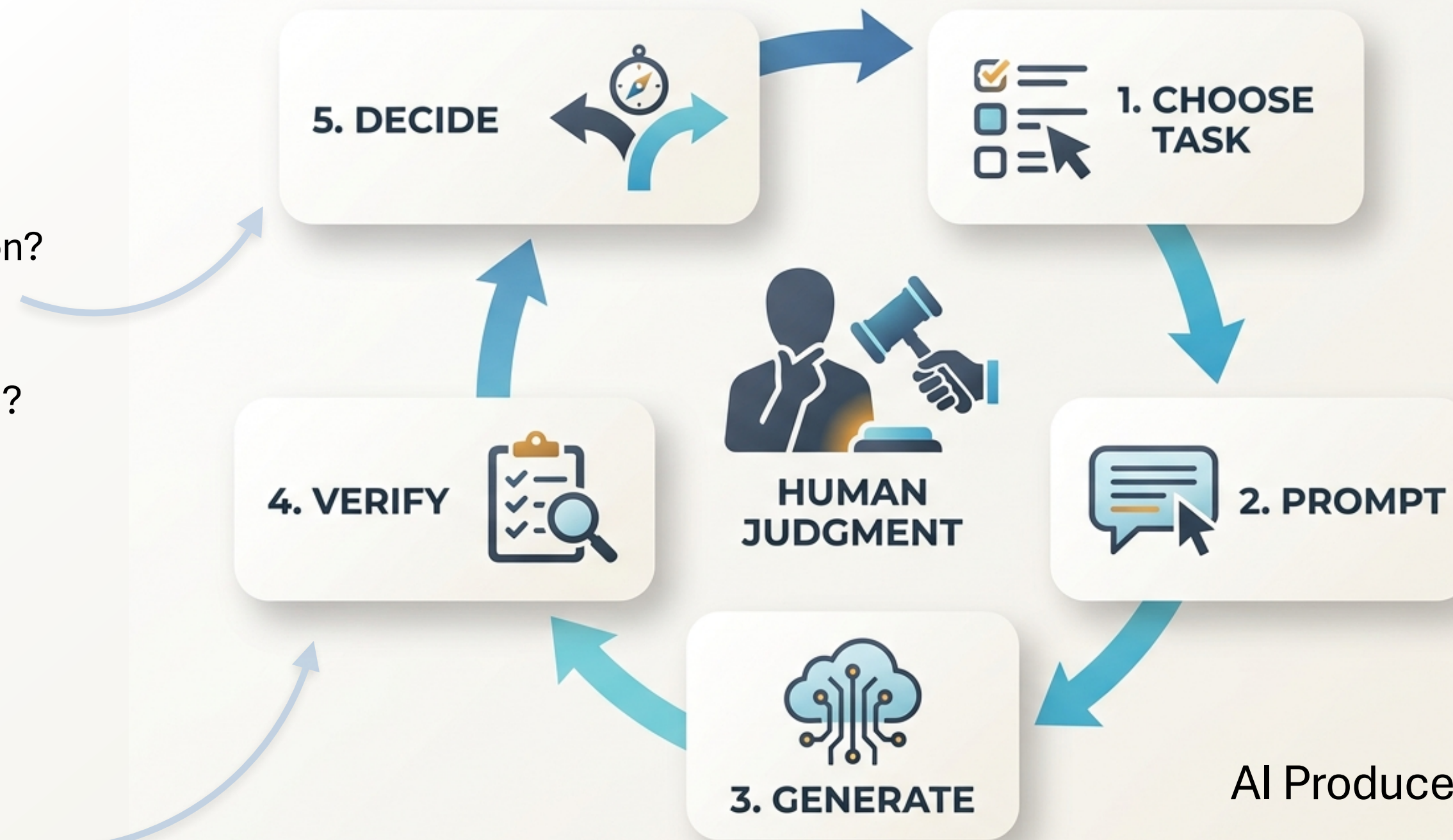
For example:

- Do we accept the recommendation?
- Do we investigate the issue?
- Do we ask for more information?
- Do we reject the recommendation?

Human verifies the output.

Ask:

- Does this make sense?
- Are the numbers correct?
- Did the AI misunderstand the question?
- Did it make assumptions?
- Did it invent something?
- Is anything important missing?



First, give AI a task.

For example:

Summarize this monthly financial report and identify the three most important issues management should investigate.

AI Produces a response.

Note:

The fact that the AI produces an answer doesn't mean that the answer is necessarily correct.

Interaction

"If an AI system gives you a recommendation that could potentially save your organization a significant amount of money, would you implement it immediately?"

Do we accept the recommendation?

Where did the information come from?

Are the numbers correct?

Is there missing information?

Does this recommendation make business sense?

What are the risks?

What can a manager use GenAI for today?

Think in work tasks — not in technology features.



DRAFT

Most of us spend an enormous amount of time writing:

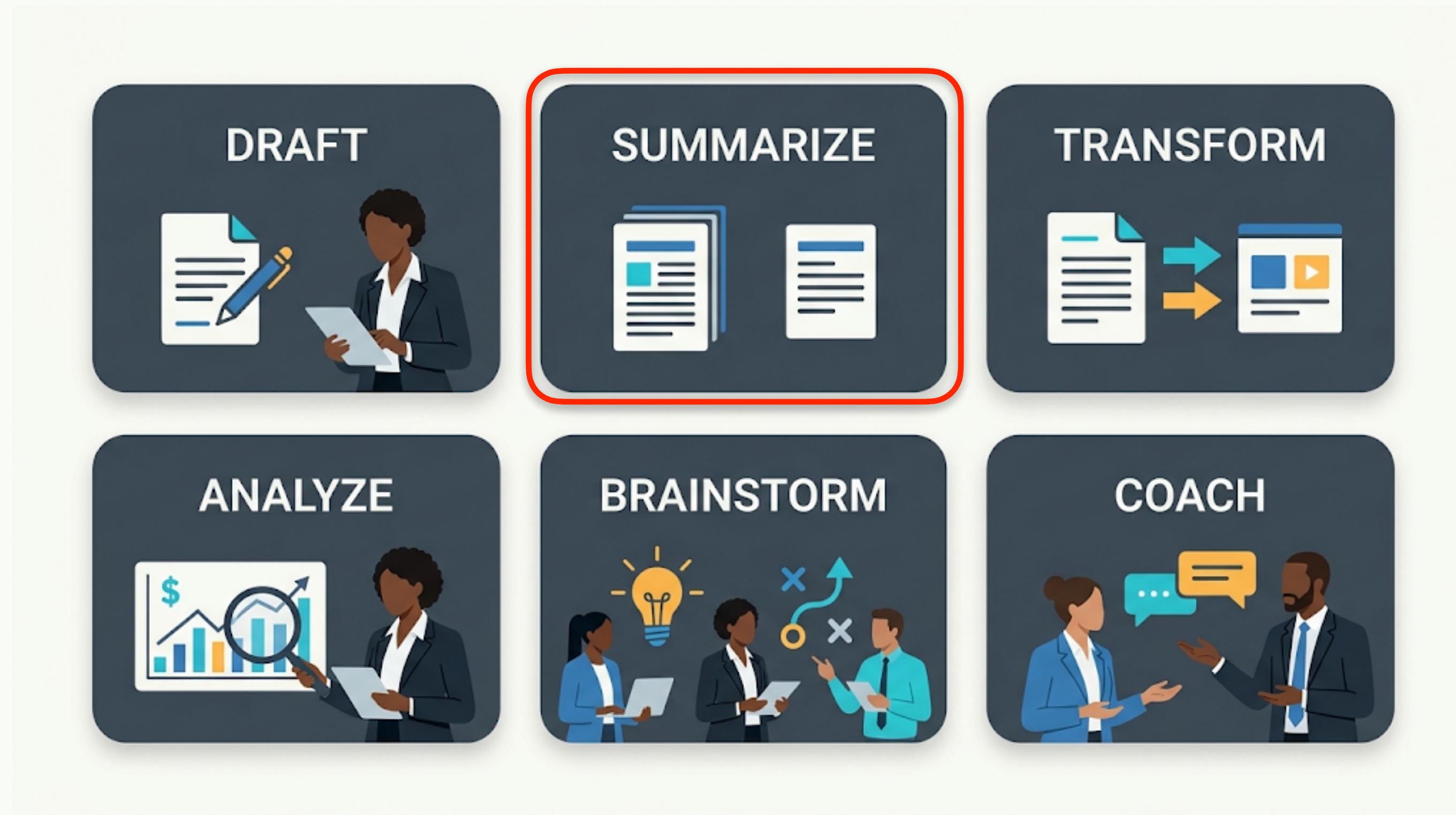
- Emails
- Memos
- Management reports
- Meeting agendas
- Briefing notes
- Proposals
- Job descriptions
- Internal announcements
- Executive summaries

Live Example

"Act as a finance manager. Draft a professional email to department heads explaining that the organization needs to reduce discretionary spending during the next quarter. Keep it constructive, concise and focused on collaboration."

What can a manager use GenAI for today?

Think in work tasks — not in technology features.



SUMMARIZE

A 30-page report →:

- Emails
- Executive summary
- Key findings
- Major risks
- Important numbers
- Questions management should ask

Examples

"Summarize this report for a senior executive. Identify the five most important findings, three risks and three questions that management should investigate."



Summarization doesn't mean you never read the original document. For important decisions, you still need to go back to the source.

What can a manager use GenAI for today?

Think in work tasks — not in technology features.



TRANSFORM

Taking existing information and changing it into a more useful format:

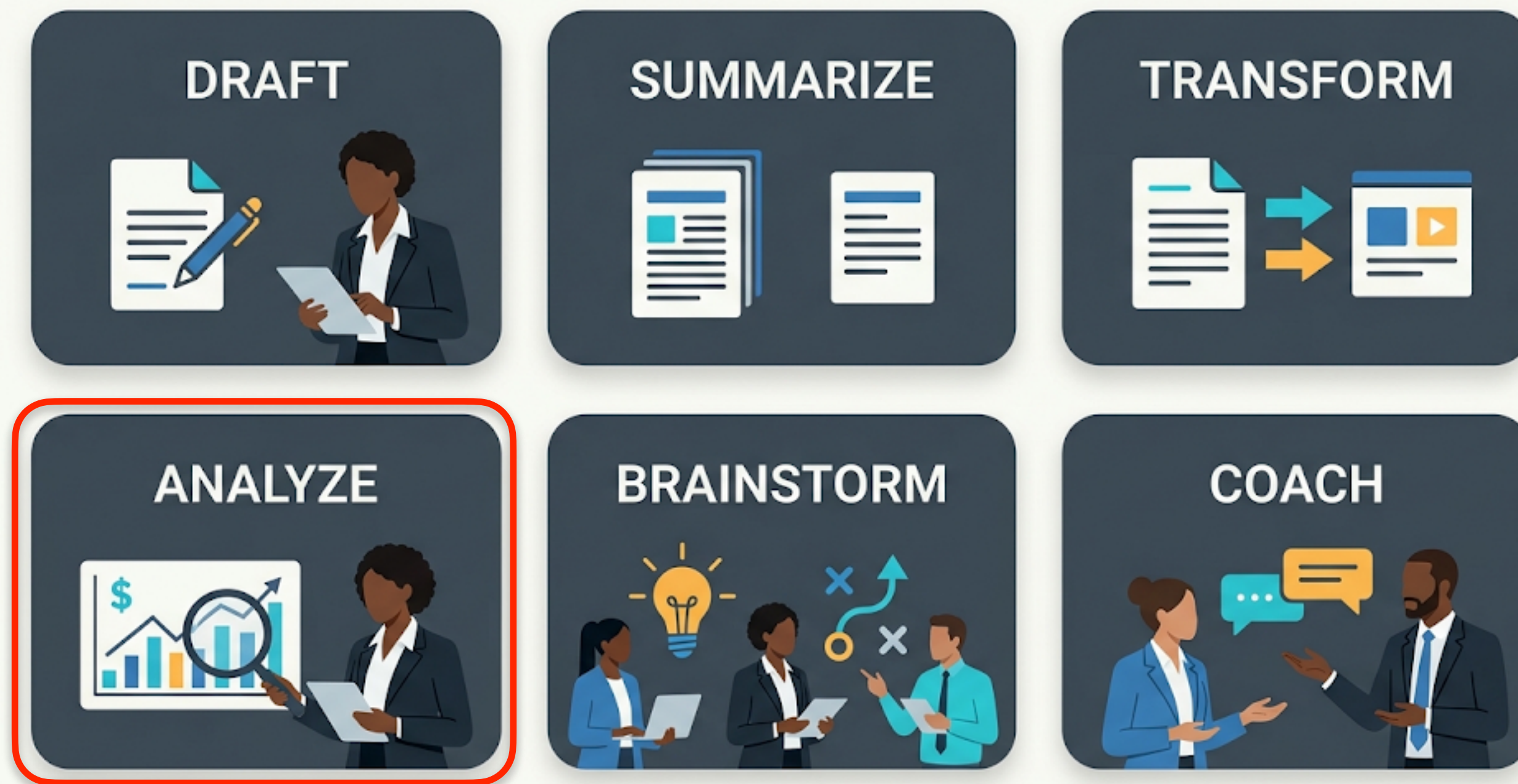
- Meeting notes → Executive summary
- Long report → One-page briefing
- Technical language → Plain English
- Bullet points → Professional memo
- Data → Management narrative
- Policy document → Staff checklist

Examples

"Rewrite this explanation for a non-financial executive audience. Keep the important numbers but explain the implications in plain language."

What can a manager use GenAI for today?

Think in work tasks — not in technology features.



ANALYZE

This is where AI becomes particularly interesting for managers and financial professionals:

- Identify trends
- Compare periods
- Identify unusual changes
- Categorize expenses
- Find themes in customer feedback
- Analyze survey responses
- Identify potential risks
- Generate questions about a financial report

Examples

*"Here is a monthly expense report. Identify the five largest changes compared with the previous month. For each change, explain what additional information **management should investigate.**"*

What can a manager use GenAI for today?

Think in work tasks — not in technology features.



BRAINSTORM

AI can help you explore a problem from multiple perspectives:

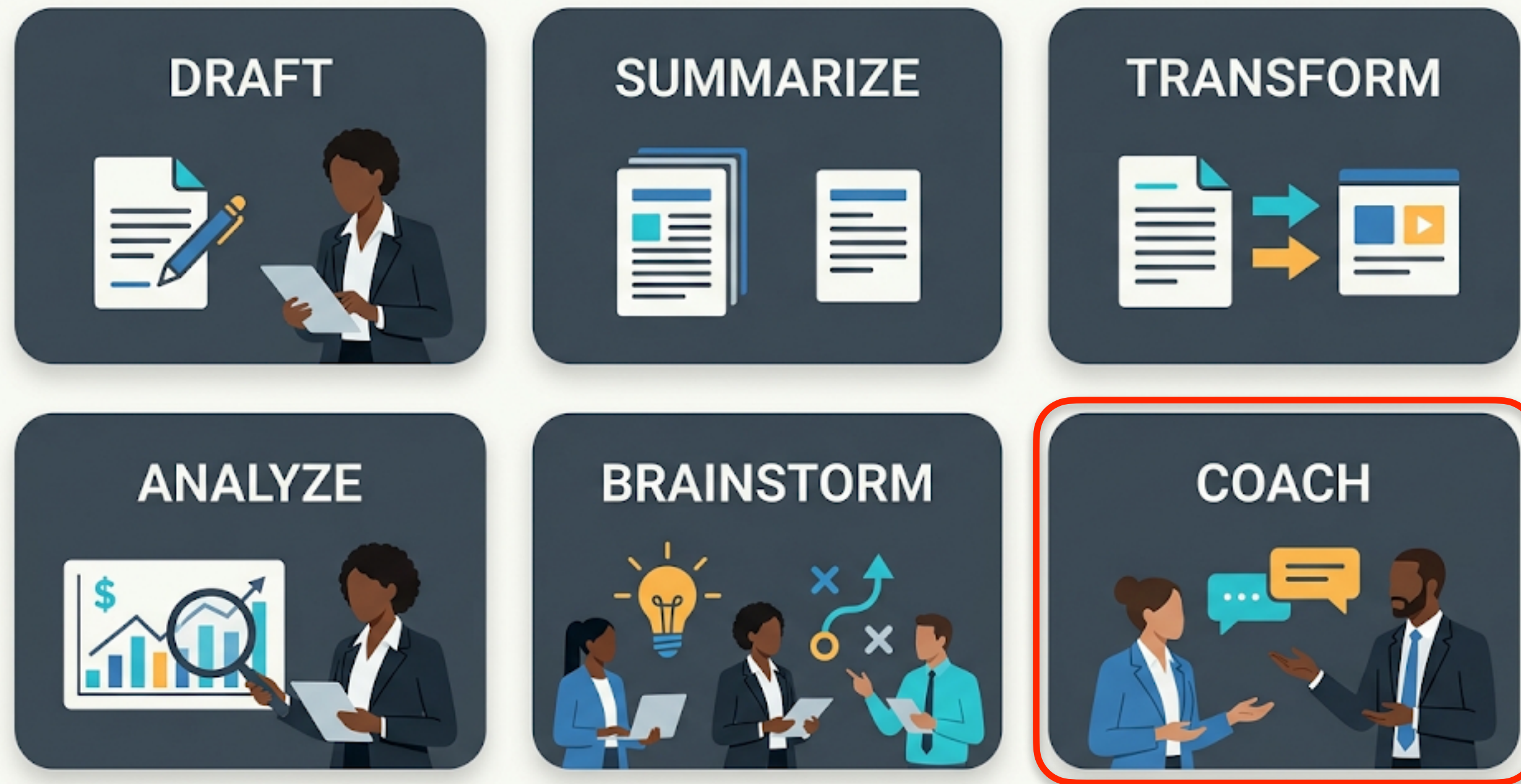
- New business ideas
- Cost-reduction options
- Marketing ideas
- Expansion strategies
- Risks
- Scenario planning
- Questions management should consider
- Alternative approaches to a problem

Examples

"We are considering expanding a hospitality business into a new regional market. Give me five strategic options, the assumptions behind each option, potential risks, and questions we should investigate before making a decision."

What can a manager use GenAI for today?

Think in work tasks — not in technology features.



COACH

AI can act as a **practice partner**:

Examples

"Act as an employee who is unhappy about a performance review. I am the manager. Role-play the conversation with me and respond realistically to what I say."

Search vs. Generation vs. Analysis

When you work with AI, you need to know whether you are trying to find something, create something, or understand something.



You're looking for **external information**.

*The first situation is when we need information. In these situations, we care about **current and authoritative information***

Examples:

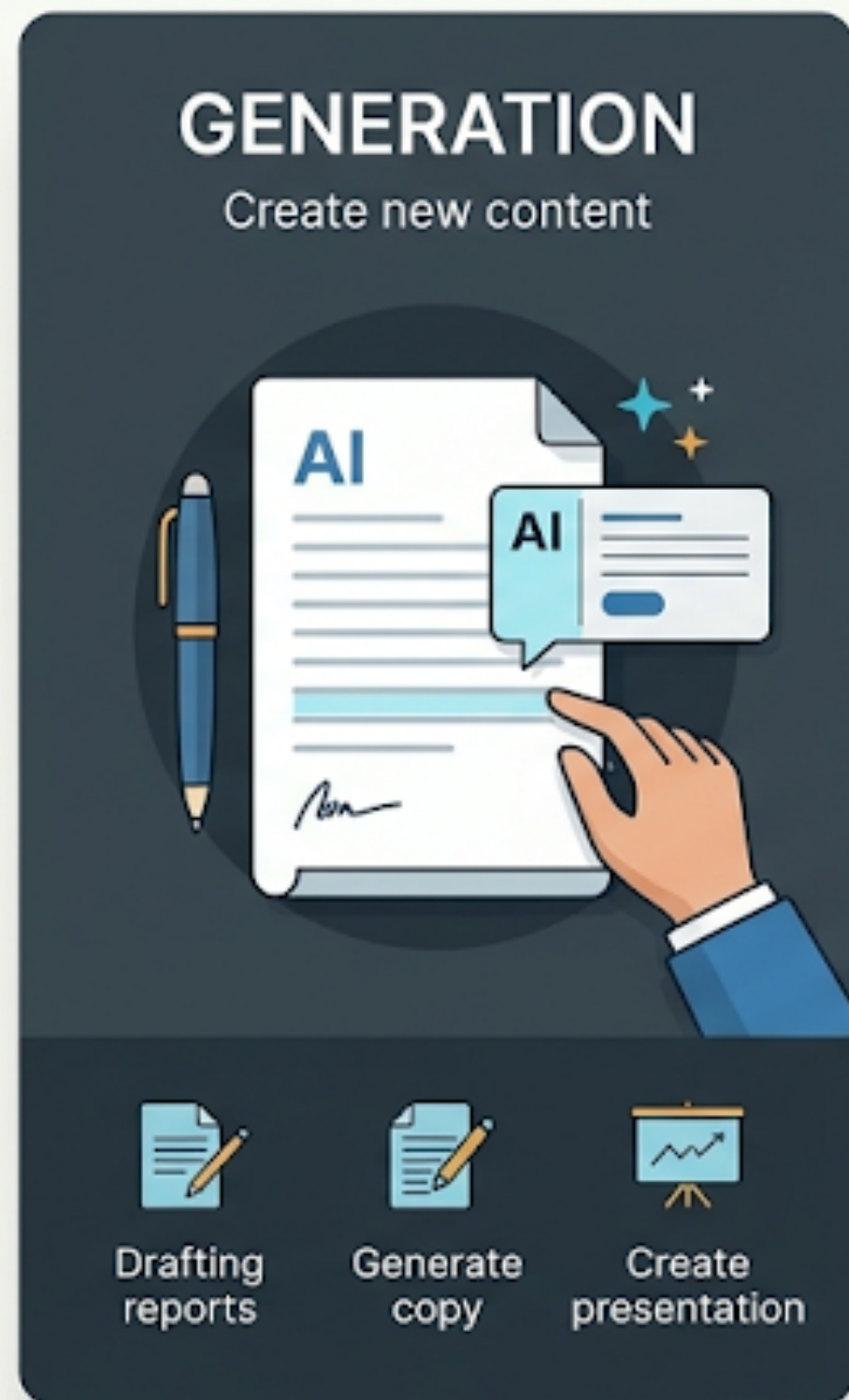
- What are the current tax regulations?
- What happened in the market this week?
- What is the latest exchange rate?
- What are the current regulations affecting our industry?



Be particularly careful about where the information comes from and whether it is current.

Search vs. Generation vs. Analysis

When you work with AI, you need to know whether you are trying to find something, create something, or understand something.



You're asking AI to create content.

The second situation is when we already know what we want to communicate, but we want AI to help us create the first version.

Examples:

- Email
- Report
- Memo
- Presentation outline
- Policy draft
- Meeting agenda
- Executive briefing

“ I need to write an email to department heads explaining a budget change.”

Search vs. Generation vs. Analysis

When you work with AI, you need to know whether you are trying to find something, create something, or understand something.



You're asking AI to **analyze information you provide.**

Examples of Questions:

- Here is our monthly expense report. What are the largest changes?
- Here is our customer feedback. What are the three most common complaints?
- Here is our financial report. What trends should management investigate?

Examples of data:

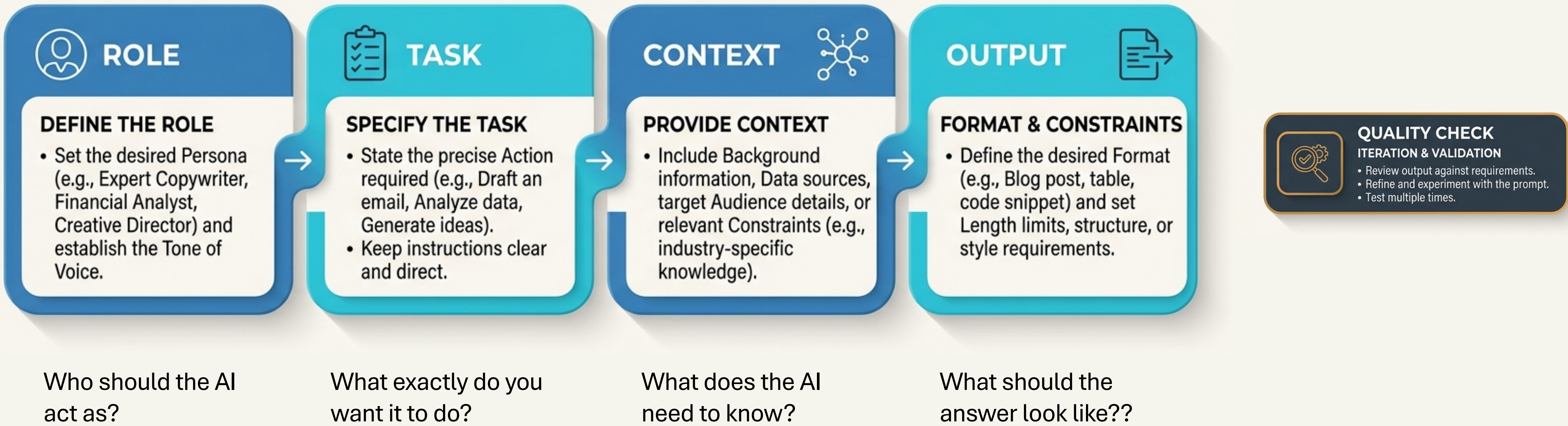
- Financial data
- Expenses
- Surveys
- Performance reports

“ Analysis helps us interpret information we already have..”

02 • PROMPT ENGINEERING

What is a prompt?

A prompt is simply the instruction or request that we give to an AI system



What is a prompt?

A prompt is simply the instruction or request that we give to an AI system

Instead of:

"Analyze this report."

*Vague instruction →
generic response*

Use:

"Act as a **finance manager**. Review this **monthly financial report** and **identify the five most significant changes** in expenses. Explain why each change may matter to **management**. Present the results in a **table with: Expense Category, Change, Possible Explanation, and Management Question.**"

*Structured instruction →
more targeted response*

Role: Finance manager

Task: Identify significant expense changes

Context: Monthly financial report + management audience

Output: Four-column table

Prompt Demo

Use Gemini or ChatGPT to analyze the following financial data

ABC Hospitality Ltd. — Monthly Management Summary

Category	Previous Month	Current Month
Payroll	\$85,000	\$91,000
Utilities	\$18,000	\$24,500
Food & Beverage	\$42,000	\$48,000
Marketing	\$15,000	\$11,000
Maintenance	\$12,000	\$21,000

Weak Prompt:

”Analyze this report.”

Strong Prompt:

”Act as a finance manager. Review this monthly financial report and identify the five most significant changes in expenses. Explain why each change may matter to management. Present the results in a table with: Expense Category, Change, Possible Explanation, and Management Question.”

A reusable executive prompt template

Copy the structure. Change the content.

ROLE : Act as a [role/expertise].

TASK : Your task is to [specific action].

CONTEXT : Here is the relevant context: [facts, audience, constraints].

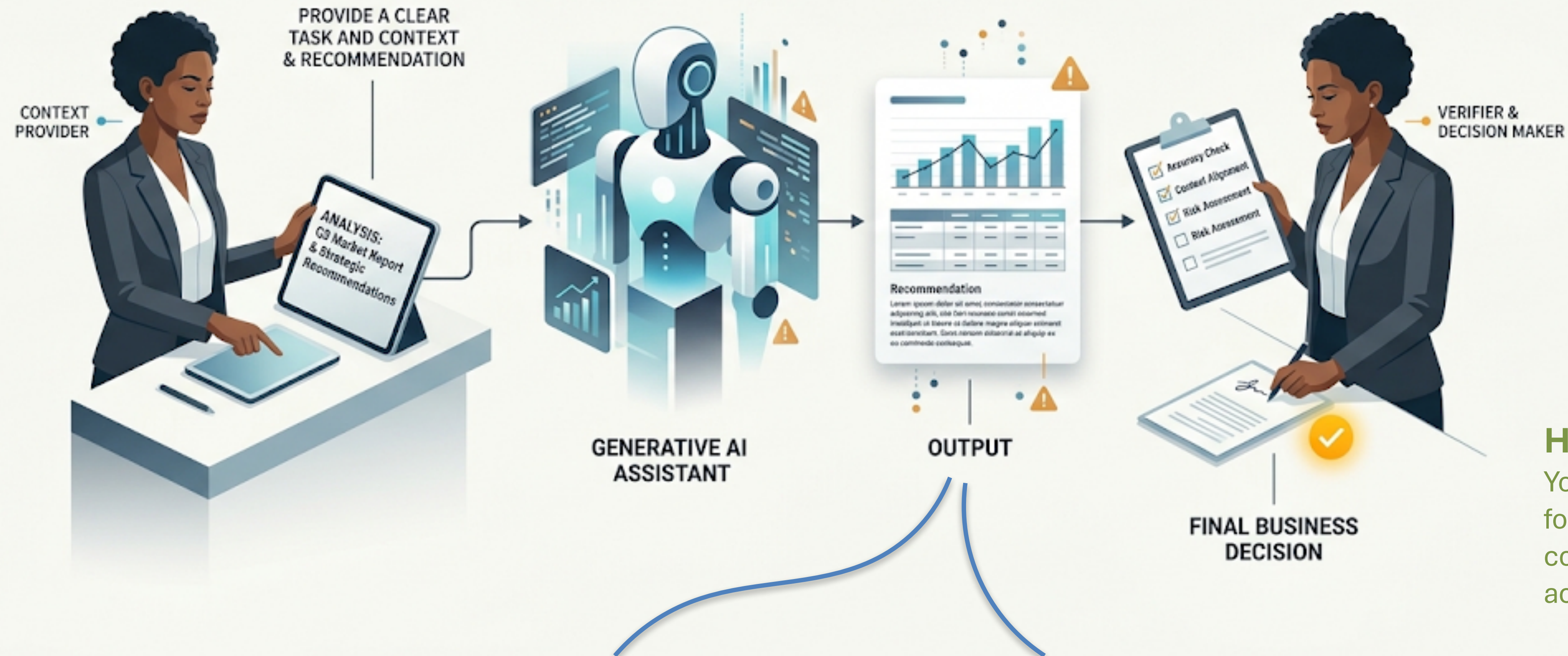
OUTPUT : Return the result as [format, length, tone, sections].

QUALITY CHECK : Before answering, identify assumptions or missing information.

03 • HUMAN-IN-THE-LOOP

Why verification is not optional

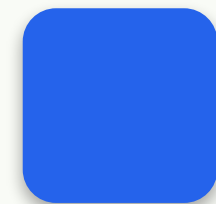
AI can produce fluent, confident answers that are incomplete or wrong.



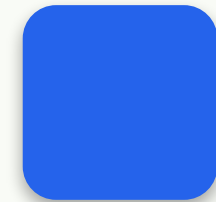
Human judgment
You remain accountable for the final decision, communication or action.

The 5-question verification habit

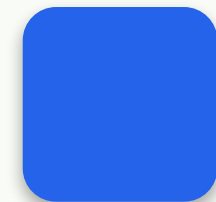
Before you copy, send, approve or act:



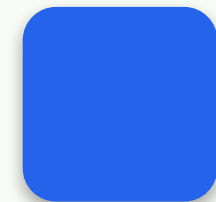
Is it factually correct?



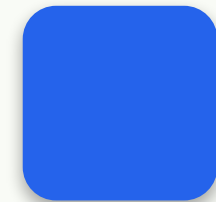
What evidence supports the important claims?



What assumptions did the AI make?



What is missing or potentially biased?



Would I be comfortable being accountable for this output?

For financial, legal, HR, medical, security or other high-stakes work: verify against authoritative sources and organizational policy.

A practical risk ladder

Not every AI task needs the same level of checking.

LOW

Formatting, brainstorming, first drafts

MEDIUM

Reports, recommendations, external communications

HIGH

Financial decisions, HR actions, legal/compliance, sensitive data

Rule of thumb: Increase verification as consequences increase.

Spot the problem

Review the AI response and decide what you would verify.

AI RESPONSE

“Based on your company's Q3 figures, operating expenses increased by 18% due mainly to travel costs. The company should immediately reduce travel spending by 25%.”

HUMAN VERIFICATION

Debrief: Separate what the AI observed from what it recommended.

- Is the 18% figure correct?
- What period and baseline?
- Does travel explain most of the increase?
- Is 25% reduction justified?
- What other causes or constraints exist?

04 • OPPORTUNITY ASSESSMENT

Where Should You Use AI?



1. Does this task happen often?

If you do something repeatedly, AI may be able to help.

Does it occur:

- Daily
- Weekly
- Monthly
- Quarterly



2. Does it take meaningful time?

If yes, there may be an opportunity to automate and optimize.

Does it involve:

- Writing
- Reading
- Summarizing
- Organizing
- Comparing
- Analyzing
- Preparing information



3. Can AI help without making the final decision?

AI assists the work, while the human remains responsible for final judgment.

AI CAN HELP

- Draft
- Summarize
- Compare
- Organize
- Analyze
- Brainstorm
- Identify patterns
- Generate options

YOU ARE RESPONSIBLE FOR

- Verify
- Judge
- Approve
- Decide
- Communicate
- Take accountability

Where Should You Use AI?

Instead of:

"AI, prepare my entire financial report."

Break it down

AI Part

Human Part

Analyze the data.

Identify unusual
changes.

Draft the
management
commentary.

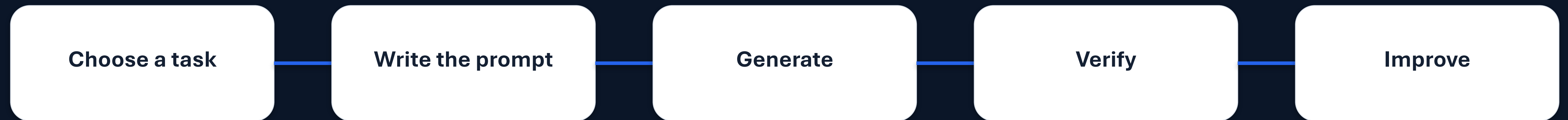
Verify the
numbers.

Interpret the
business context.

Approve the
report.

Your first AI leadership workflow

A repeatable cycle you can use immediately.



The goal is not perfect prompting.

The goal is a disciplined habit of using AI, checking it, and learning from the interaction.

Takeaway: start small, repeat often, verify intelligently.

Questions, challenges, and your real-world use cases.

30 minutes

Bring the task you most want AI to help you solve.

